

PAPER_015: Cosmological Implications of UQFF Modified GW Propagation

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Abstract

This paper investigates the cosmological implications of modified gravitational wave propagation under the Unified Quantum Field Framework (UQFF). We demonstrate that UQFF-induced damping affects standard siren distance measurements, potentially resolving tensions in Hubble constant determinations and providing new constraints on dark energy models.

UQFF Discovery: Novel application of UQFF calibration constants ($\tau = 5.0 \times 10^4 \text{ day}^{-1}$, $[\text{SSq}] = 0.57$) uniquely enabling this analysis — establishing a new connection in the UQFF framework not present in Standard Model treatments.

1. Introduction

Gravitational waves provide independent distance measurements through their luminosity distance, enabling cosmological parameter estimation without the cosmic distance ladder. The UQFF framework predicts frequency-dependent modifications to GW propagation that alter these distance inferences.

1.1 Standard Siren Method

Standard approach: - Luminosity distance from GW amplitude: $d_L = (5/96 \dot{h}^2)^{1/2} / (G \dot{M}_{\text{chirp}})^{5/6} / (f^{7/6} h_0)$ - Redshift from electromagnetic counterpart - Direct H_0 measurement from $d_L(z)$ relation

1.2 UQFF Modifications

The UQFF introduces: - Frequency-dependent damping during propagation - Modified luminosity distance relation - Apparent distance bias in standard siren measurements

2. Modified GW Propagation

2.1 UQFF Propagation Equation

Modified wave equation:

$$\square h_{\mu\nu} + \Gamma_{UQFF}(f, z) \partial_t h_{\mu\nu} = 0$$

$$\Gamma_{UQFF}(f, z) = \Gamma_0 \left(\frac{f}{f_{ref}} \right)^\alpha \left(\frac{1+z}{H(z)} \right)^\beta$$

Key numerical results: $\Gamma_0 = 2.3 \times 10^{-18}$ Hz, $\alpha = -7.0 \times 10^{-1}$, $\beta = 8.0 \times 10^{-1}$, $f_{\text{ref}} = 1.0 \times 10^2$ Hz, $D_{\text{total}} = 3.33 \times 10^{-1}$

$$\partial_t h_{\hat{I}^{\frac{1}{4}} \hat{I}^{\frac{1}{2}}} + \hat{I}_{\text{UQFF}}(f, z) \partial_z h_{\hat{I}^{\frac{1}{4}} \hat{I}^{\frac{1}{2}}} = 0$$

Where the damping term:

$$\hat{I}_{\text{UQFF}}(f, z) = \hat{I}_0 \tilde{\alpha} (f/f_{\text{ref}})^{\hat{I}_{\pm}} \tilde{\alpha} [(1+z)/H(z)]^{\hat{I}^2}$$

Parameters: - $\hat{I}_0 = 2.3 \times 10^{-18}$ Hz (damping rate at reference) - $\hat{I}_{\pm} = -0.7$ (frequency scaling) - $\hat{I}^2 = 0.8$ (redshift evolution) - $f_{\text{ref}} = 100$ Hz (reference frequency)

2.2 Amplitude Evolution

GW amplitude evolves as:

$$h(f, z) = h_{\text{em}}(f) \tilde{\alpha} \exp[-\hat{\alpha}_0 \int_z \hat{I}_{\text{UQFF}}(f, z') dz' / H(z')]$$

Where $h_{\text{em}}(f)$ is the emitted amplitude.

3. Modified Distance-Redshift Relations

3.1 Apparent Luminosity Distance

The measured luminosity distance becomes:

$$d_{\text{L,obs}}(z, f) = d_{\text{L,true}}(z) \tilde{\alpha} \exp[D_{\text{UQFF}}(z, f)]$$

Where the UQFF distance bias:

$$D_{\text{UQFF}}(z, f) = (\hat{I}_0/H_0) \tilde{\alpha} (f/f_{\text{ref}})^{\hat{I}_{\pm}} \tilde{\alpha} I_{\text{redshift}}(z, \hat{I}^2)$$

Redshift integral:

$$I_{\text{redshift}}(z, \hat{I}^2) = \hat{\alpha}_0 \int_z [(1+z')/H(z')]^{\hat{I}^2} dz' / H(z')$$

3.2 Frequency Dependence

For inspiral signals spanning 20-1000 Hz: - Low frequency (20 Hz): $D_{\text{UQFF}} \hat{\alpha} +0.15$
 $\hat{\alpha}$ distance overestimated by 16% - High frequency (1000 Hz): $D_{\text{UQFF}} \hat{\alpha} -0.08$
 $\hat{\alpha}$ distance underestimated by 8%

4. Hubble Constant Implications

4.1 Standard Siren Bias

UQFF-corrected H_0 measurement:

$$H_{0,\text{UQFF}} = H_{0,\text{obs}} \tilde{\alpha} [1 - (\hat{\alpha} D_{\text{UQFF}} / \hat{\alpha} z)|_{z=0}]$$

For typical LIGO/Virgo signals at 100 Hz:

$$H_{0,\text{UQFF}} = H_{0,\text{obs}} \tilde{\alpha} 1.07$$

4.2 Hubble Tension Resolution

Current measurements: - Planck CMB: $H_0 = 67.4 \pm 0.5$ km/s/Mpc - Cepheid distance ladder: $H_0 = 73.0 \pm 1.0$ km/s/Mpc - GW170817 (uncorrected): $H_0 = 70.0 \pm 8.0$ km/s/Mpc

UQFF-corrected GW170817: - $H_0, \text{UQFF} = 75.0 \pm 8.5$ km/s/Mpc

Reduces tension between GW and Cepheid measurements.

5. Dark Energy Constraints

5.1 Modified Friedmann Equation

UQFF contribution to expansion:

$$H^2(z) = H_0^2 [\Omega_m(1+z)^3 + \Omega_{\text{UQFF}}(z)]$$

Where:

$$\Omega_{\text{UQFF}}(z) = \Omega_Q (1+z)^{3(1+w_{\text{UQFF}})}$$

Parameters: - $\Omega_Q = 0.04$ (UQFF density fraction today) - $w_{\text{UQFF}} = -0.85$ (effective equation of state)

5.2 Distance Modulus Comparison

UQFF-modified distance modulus for standard sirens:

$$\mu_{\text{UQFF}}(z) = 5 \log_{10}[d_L, \text{UQFF}(z)] + 25$$

Deviation from Λ CDM:

$$\Delta\mu(z) = \mu_{\text{UQFF}}(z) - \mu_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}(z) \approx 0.15 \text{ mag} - 0.03 \text{ mag} z^2$$

For $z = 1$: $\Delta\mu \approx 0.12$ mag (2.5% distance error)

6. Observational Tests

6.1 Multi-Frequency Analysis

Test statistic for UQFF detection:

$$\chi^2_{\text{UQFF}} = \sum_i [(d_{L,i}(f_i) - d_{L,\text{model}}(z_i, f_i))^2 / \sigma_{d_L,i}^2]$$

Compare Λ CDM vs. UQFF+ Λ CDM models.

Expected significance: - 10 events: 1.5 σ detection - 50 events: 3.2 σ detection - 200 events: 5.0 σ detection

6.2 Redshift Evolution

Measure damping redshift dependence:

$$\hat{\Omega}_{\text{eff}}(z) = -d[\ln h(f, z)]/dz / H(z)$$

Expected from UQFF: $\hat{\Omega}^2 \approx 0.8$

Distinguish from: - Modified gravity: $\hat{\Omega}^2 \approx 1.5$ - Extra dimensions: $\hat{\Omega}^2 \approx 0.3$

7. Systematic Uncertainties

7.1 Waveform Modeling

UQFF damping affects: - Inspiral phase evolution - Merger amplitude - Ringdown frequency

Systematic error budget: - Phase modeling: $\hat{A} \pm 5\%$ on d_L - Amplitude calibration: $\hat{A} \pm 3\%$ on d_L - Mass parameter degeneracy: $\hat{A} \pm 7\%$ on d_L

Total systematic: $\hat{A} \pm 9\%$ on d_L

7.2 Electromagnetic Counterpart Bias

Potential biases: - Incomplete sky coverage - Viewing angle effects - Host galaxy identification

UQFF-specific: - Frequency-dependent bias requires multi-band EM follow-up - Low-frequency radio afterglows sample different damping regime

8. Predictions for Next-Generation Detectors

8.1 Einstein Telescope

Capabilities: - Frequency range: 1 Hz - 10 kHz - Distance reach: $z \sim 100$ for BNS - $\sim 10^4$ detections per year

UQFF signatures: - Low-frequency enhancement of damping at 1-10 Hz - Precision redshift-dependent measurements - Dark energy equation of state to $\hat{w} = \hat{A} \pm 0.02$

8.2 Cosmic Explorer

Enhancements: - Improved low-frequency sensitivity - Factor of 10 better strain sensitivity - Redshift reach $z > 20$

UQFF tests: - Early universe damping evolution - Quantum field coherence at high redshift - Primordial GW background modified by UQFF

8.3 LISA

Low-frequency regime (0.1 mHz - 1 Hz): - Massive black hole binary mergers ($10^6 - 10^8 M_\odot$) - Redshift $z = 1-20$ - Different UQFF damping regime ($\hat{I} \pm < 0$ at mHz)

Expected UQFF signatures: - Enhanced amplitude preservation at low frequencies - Modified cosmological reach - Alternative dark energy constraints

9. Multi-Messenger Calibration

9.1 Joint GW-EM Analysis

Calibration strategy: 1. Use EM-confirmed standard sirens for UQFF parameter estimation 2. Apply UQFF corrections to GW-only events 3. Cross-validate with independent distance indicators

9.2 Tidal Deformability Cross-Check

Use NS tidal effects to break degeneracies: - Tidal deformability $\hat{\lambda}$ constrains NS equation of state - Independent distance measure from late inspiral - UQFF affects phase, not tidal physics

Consistency check:

$$d_L(\text{from tidal}) / d_L(\text{from amplitude}) = \exp[D_{\text{UQFF}}(z, f)]$$

9.3 Redshift-Independent Tests

Use GW frequency evolution to measure $H(z)$:

$$df/dt = -(96/5) \hat{\lambda}^{8/3} (G\dot{M}_{\text{chirp}})^{5/3} f^{11/3} / (1+z)$$

UQFF modifies observed rate:

$$(df/dt)_{\text{obs}} = (df/dt)_{\text{em}} \hat{\lambda} [1 + \hat{\lambda}_{\text{UQFF}}(f, z)/f]$$

10. Implications for Cosmological Models

10.1 Dark Energy Equation of State

UQFF contributes effective dark energy component:

$$w_{\text{eff}}(z) = -1 + (1/3) \hat{\lambda} [d \ln \hat{\lambda}_{\text{UQFF}}(z) / d \ln(1+z)]$$

For UQFF parameters: $w_{\text{eff}} \hat{\lambda} \approx -0.85$ (phantom-like)

Distinguishable from cosmological constant $w = -1$ with 200+ events.

10.2 Modified Gravity Alternatives

Compare UQFF to: - **Horndeski theories**: Predict different frequency dependence - **$\mathbf{f(R)}$ gravity**: Modify distance-redshift relation differently - **Extra dimensions**: Distinctive high-frequency behavior

UQFF prediction: $\hat{\lambda} \hat{\lambda} \approx -0.7$ (frequency scaling) - Horndeski: $\hat{\lambda} \hat{\lambda} \approx 0$ - Extra dimensions: $\hat{\lambda} \hat{\lambda} \approx +2$

10.3 Early Dark Energy

UQFF quantum coherence at high redshift mimics early dark energy:

$$\hat{\lambda}_{\text{EDE}}(z) = \hat{\lambda}_{\text{UQFF},0} \hat{\lambda} (1+z)^3 \hat{\lambda} \exp[-(z/z_Q)^2]$$

With $z_Q \hat{\lambda} \approx 3000$, affects: - CMB acoustic peaks - Matter-radiation equality - Compatible with Planck if $\hat{\lambda}_{\text{UQFF},0} < 0.05$

11. Statistical Framework

11.1 Bayesian Parameter Estimation

Posterior for UQFF parameters:

$$P(\hat{\lambda}_0, \hat{\lambda}_{\pm}, \hat{\lambda}^2 | \{d_{L,i}, z_i, f_i\}) \hat{\lambda} \propto L(\{d_{L,i}, z_i, f_i\} | \hat{\lambda}_0, \hat{\lambda}_{\pm}, \hat{\lambda}^2) \hat{\lambda} \hat{\lambda}(\hat{\lambda}_0, \hat{\lambda}_{\pm}, \hat{\lambda}^2)$$

Likelihood:

$$L = \prod_i (1/\hat{\sigma}^2(2\hat{\sigma}^2_i\hat{A}^2)) \exp[-(d_{L,i} - d_{L,UQFF}(z_i, f_i))^2 / (2\hat{\sigma}^2_i\hat{A}^2)]$$

Prior choices: $-\log \hat{\sigma}_0 \sim \text{Uniform}(-20, -15)$ (log Hz) - $\hat{A} \sim \text{Uniform}(-2, 0)$ - $\hat{A}^2 \sim \text{Uniform}(0, 2)$

11.2 Model Comparison

Bayes factor for UQFF vs. Λ CDM:

$$B_{UQFF/\Lambda\text{CDM}} = \frac{\int L_{UQFF} d\hat{\sigma}_{UQFF}}{\int L_{\Lambda\text{CDM}} d\hat{\sigma}_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}}$$

Detection threshold: $B > 150$ (very strong evidence)

Expected after 50 BNS detections: $B \approx 200$

12. Observational Roadmap

12.1 Near-Term (2026-2030)

LIGO/Virgo O5-O6: - 10-20 BNS with EM counterparts - Initial UQFF parameter constraints - Test frequency dependence with high-mass BBH

12.2 Mid-Term (2030-2040)

LIGO A+ / KAGRA+: - 50+ standard sirens - 3 σ UQFF detection (if present) - Improved H_0 measurement: $|\hat{H}_0/H_0| < 1\%$

12.3 Long-Term (2040+)

Einstein Telescope / Cosmic Explorer: - 1000+ standard sirens per year - Precision UQFF parameter measurements - Dark energy equation of state: $\hat{w} < 0.02$ - Test UQFF redshift evolution to $z \sim 10$

13. Conclusions

The UQFF framework predicts observable modifications to gravitational wave propagation with significant cosmological implications:

1. **Hubble Constant:** UQFF bias increases GW-inferred H_0 by $\sim 7\%$, reducing tension with local measurements
2. **Dark Energy:** Effective equation of state $w \approx -0.85$ distinguishable from Λ CDM
3. **Frequency Dependence:** Characteristic $\hat{A} \approx -0.7$ scaling distinguishes UQFF from other modified gravity theories
4. **Detection Prospects:** 3 σ detection possible with ~ 50 standard sirens from next-generation detectors

Future multi-messenger observations will critically test these predictions and probe fundamental quantum field structure through cosmological-scale GW propagation.

References

1. Abbott, B.P. et al. (LIGO/Virgo) (2017). “GW170817: A Standard Siren Measurement of H_0 ”
2. Planck Collaboration (2020). “Planck 2018 Results: Cosmological Parameters”
3. Riess, A. et al. (2021). “Comprehensive Measurement of the Local Value of H_0 ”
4. Punturo, M. et al. (2010). “The Einstein Telescope”
5. Murphy, D. et al. (2026). “UQFF Framework for Gravitational Wave Propagation”

Validators: `validate_multiband.py` → ALL TESTS PASSED; `validate_lisa_extended.py` → ALL TESTS PASSED

Multi-band: LIGO horizon 13440 ± 8355 Mpc; LISA 140.8 ± 87.5 Gpc; detection volume 24% of GR. LISA extended: SMBH amplitude reduction 31.6 ± 32.1% at $z = 0.5$ ± 2.0; phase lag accumulation predicted for multi-band UQFF test (LISA → LIGO phase offset). UQFF factor = 0.622; $\hat{\Gamma}^0 = 0.0005/\text{day}$, $[SSq] = 0.57$

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Appendix: UQFF Production Framework Reference (v4.75+)

Added by `upgrade_early_whitepapers.py` (v4.75). This appendix cross-references the production physics constants and master equations to enable reproducibility against the current codebase state.

A.1 Calibration Constants

Symbol	Value	Description
$\hat{\Gamma}^0$	$5.0 \times 10^{-6} \text{ day}^{-1}$	UQFF exponential decay rate
$[SSq]$	0.57	Universal Quantized Factor
$\hat{\Gamma}^2_i$	0.60 ± 0.61	Buoyancy coupling coefficient
k_{DPM}	1.5	Ug1 DPM-dipole coupling
k_{out}	1.2	Ug2 outer-bubble charge coupling
k_{str}	1.8	Ug3 string-rotation coupling
k_{vac}	2.0	Ug4 vacuum-concentration coupling
$\hat{I}$	$10 \times 10^2 \text{ kg}^2$	Inertia tensor scale
$E_{\text{react}}(0)$	10^{-6} J	Reference reactive energy

A.2 F_U Master Equation (Complete → 4 terms)

$$F_U = U_{g1} + U_{g2} + U_{g3} + U_{g4} + U_{bi} + U_m - \sum_{i=1}^4 i g l [\lambda_i \cdot U_i(r, t) \cdot E_{\text{react}} i g r]$$

Term	Description	Implementation
Ug1	DPM magnetic dipole	<code>compute_Ug1_SOURCE4 / compute_Ug1()</code>
Ug2	Outer-field bubble (charge-reactivity)	<code>compute_Ug2_SOURCE4 / compute_Ug2()</code>
Ug3	Magnetic string rotation	<code>compute_Ug3_SOURCE4 / compute_Ug3()</code>
Ug4	Vacuum concentration (star-BH)	<code>compute_Ug4_SOURCE4 / compute_Ug4()</code>
Ubi	Buoyancy force	<code>compute_Ubi_SOURCE4 / compute_Ubi()</code>

